



OPAL ASTHANA is soft-spoken and picks his words carefully. It suits the slow-paced business he runs well. As CEO of Tata Cliq, he explains, the concept is to “encourage consumers to pause, reflect and engage meaningfully with the stories and heritage behind every brand and product.”

Tata Cliq Luxury was launched in 2016 when the management realised there was a fundamental gap in India’s luxury retail landscape. “While the demand for luxury products was growing steadily across the country, access remained limited due to the scarcity of premium retail spaces,” he says. That was enough for the conglomerate to create a differentiated platform to bridge this gap. Asthana recalls that the timing was significant, since Indian consumers were becoming more digitally savvy, with growing confidence in shopping for high-value categories online.

42 | The more important part was in customers coming not just from the metros but across the country. Today, the platform has over 1,500 premium, luxury global and Indian brands across a slew of categories that include accessories, beauty and fragrance, fashion, jewellery, home, fitness, and watches.

India’s luxury market is gradually moving away from catering specifically to generational affluence to tap into the rising aspirational section of the population. This rising class of consumers is well-travelled and has more spending power.

India is home to the largest share of the world’s youth population, and a large chunk of that is first-time luxury buyers. The older segment, with high disposable incomes, forms another critical part of the luxury story. Be it fancy malls, expensive gadgets, new-age automobiles, phones, jewellery, sprawling homes, and apparel, there is no indication of it abating. Unsurprisingly, our own conglomerates have made interesting moves to get a rightful share of the consumer wallet. Indian luxury is at a point where growth is set to take off quite dramatically, and the big boys are drawing up interesting strategies.

From an Indian point of view, luxury has been around for long. “Diamonds were first found in the Golconda mines, and silk was exported. The *maharajas* and princely states always promoted luxury goods and lifestyle,” Ashok Som, Professor of Global Strategy, ESSEC Business School, says. Cartier, in fact, used to come from Paris to take orders. “For Indian consumers, luxury is not new compared to other markets that either came out of poverty (Singapore and Hong Kong) or where it

What the Big T are doing in lux

TATA GROUP



BUSINESS SEGMENTS

► Jewellery, hospitality, automobiles, slow luxury

PROMINENT LUXURY BRANDS

► Tanishq, Taj Hotels, Jaguar Land Rover, Tata Cliq Slow Luxury

THE INDIAN LUXURY MARKET

• India’s luxury market is now catering to the rising aspirational section



NOTE *PROJECTED

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